

# **Modal Auxiliary Verbs**

# 1. CARACTERÍSTICA GERAIS:

1.1 São seguidos de outros verbos no infinitivo sem ***TO***, exceto o verbo ***OUGHT***, que é sempre seguido de ***TO*** + *infinitivo*.

1.2 Não têm o ***S/ES/IES*** nas 3<sup>as</sup> pessoas do singular (***HE, SHE, IT***) no *Simple Present*.

1.3 Não utilizam verbo auxiliar em **interrogativas**. Nelas, o modal aparece antes do sujeito. Também não usam verbo auxiliar nas **negativas**.

## 2. CAN (can't/cannot/can not):

Indica capacidade/habilidade, grande probabilidade, permissão (linguagem informal) ou pedido/sugestão.

- *We can do it!*

- *Chickens can't/cannot fly.*

- *She can win the lottery.*

- *Can I come in?*

- *You can't/cannot leave now.*

- *I am bored. Can/Can't we go now?*

**2.1 COULD:** passado ou conditional de *can* (*couldn't/could not*).

- *I couldn't watch that horror movie.*
- *Father said I could watch TV.*
- *I could help you if you weren't so stubborn.*

**2.2 WAS/WERE ABLE TO:** passado *can* (*wasn't/weren't able to*).

- *She wasn't able to beat the challenger.*

**2.3 WILL BE ABLE TO:** futuro de *can* (*won't be able to*).

- *When holidays come, I will be able to travel.*

### 3. MAY (may not):

Indica permissão (formal), certa probabilidade ou votos/desejos de que algo aconteça.

- *May I ask you your name?*
- *I can't find him at home. He may be hiding in the forest.*
- *May you stay forever young!*

### **3.1 MIGHT (might not):**

Pode ser o passado ou conditional de *may*. Ou ainda, pode ser equivalente ao *may* geralmente indicando menor probabilidade.

- *If I drank some coffee, I might stay awake.*
- *He might not look like it, but he is dangerous.*
- *I was scared when he said I might lose my job.*

### **3.2 MAY/MIGHT + have + Past Participle:**

Indica algo que pode/poderia ter ocorrido.

- *I might have fallen in love with her if she weren't a fascist. (Não ocorreu)*
- *I may have eaten all the food.*

## **4. MUST (mustn't/must not):**

Indica **obrigação/necessidade** (*have/has to*) ou **dedução**.

- *We must do our job.* (Obrigação)
- *The lights are on. There must be someone at home.* (Dedução)

## **4.1 WILL HAVE TO / HAD TO:**

Respectivamente, **futuro** e **passado** de *must* para **obrigação e necessidade**.

- *Someone will have to deal with this problem.*
- *They had to fix my computer! I've paid for it!*

## **4.2 MUST + have + Past Participle:**

Indica que algo deve ter ocorrido (DEDUÇÃO).

- *I can't find him. He must have gone home.*
- *I don't remember. I must have been distracted.*

**OBS:** ***MUST NOT*** normalmente indica **proibição** enquanto que ***NEED NOT*** indica **não obrigação, não necessidade**.

- *You must not cross the yellow line in the subway.*
- *You need not worry. I will help you.*



## **5. SHOULD e OUGHT TO:**

Normalmente indicam **conselho, recomendação, expectativa.**

- *You should/ought to study more if you want to pass.*
- *You should/ought to meet my friend. You will like him.*
- *They should/ought to be home by dinner time.*

**5.1 SHOULD** também pode ser usado para indicar **condicional:**

- *I'll be waiting downstairs should you need me.*
- *Should you want to speak, raise your hand.*

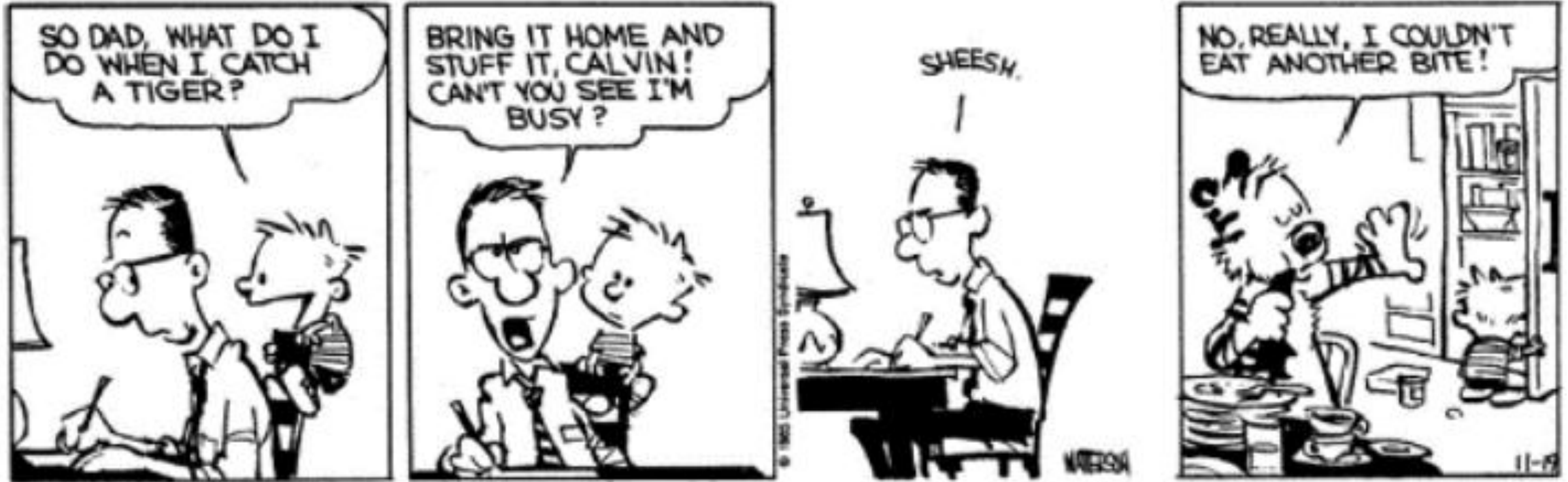
## **5.2 SHOULD / OUGHT TO + have + past participle:**

Indicam que algo deveria ter ocorrido, mas não ocorreu.

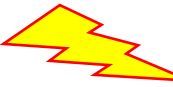
- *She should/ought to have listened to her mother.*

- *I should/ought to have spoken the truth.*

**OBS:** suas formas negativas são **shouldn't** e **ought not to**.



In the last strip the modal verb couldn't could be replaced, without changing its meaning, by

- A) mustn't
- B) wasn't supposed to
- C) shouldn't
- D) might not
-  E) am not able to

**Explique onde reside o efeito de humor da tirinha.**

## UNESP 2015



A expressão “instead of” equivale, em português, a

- (A) ainda que.
- (B) ao mesmo tempo em que.
- (C) depois de.
- (D) logo que.
- (E) em vez de.

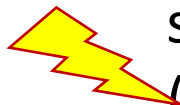
No contexto do quadrinho, o termo “can” indica uma ideia de

- (A) habilidade.
- (B) conhecimento.
- (C) pedido.
- (D) obrigação.
- (E) certeza.

## UNESP 2017

Many people think they can teach themselves to need less sleep, but they're wrong, said Dr. Sigrid Veasey, a professor at the Center for Sleep and Circadian Neurobiology at the University of Pennsylvania's Perelman School of Medicine. We **might** feel that we're getting by fine on less sleep, but we're deluding ourselves, Dr. Veasey said, largely because lack of sleep skews our self-awareness. "The more you deprive yourself of sleep over long periods of time, the less accurate you are of judging your own sleep perception," she said.

No trecho do primeiro parágrafo "We **might** feel that we're getting by fine on less sleep", o termo em destaque pode ser substituído, sem alteração de sentido, por

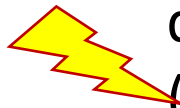


- (A) could.
- (B) ought to.
- (C) will.
- (D) should.
- (E) has to.

## UNESP 2017

But for Mendes da Rocha, who received the 2017 gold medal from the Royal Institute of British Architects this week – an accolade previously bestowed on such luminaries as Le Corbusier and Frank Lloyd Wright – the ground is everything. He has spent his 60-year career lifting his massive concrete buildings up, in gravity-defying balancing acts, or else burying them below ground in an attempt to liberate the Earth’s surface as a continuous democratic public realm. “The city has to be for everybody,” he says, “not just for the very few.”

No trecho do segundo parágrafo “The city **has to** be for everybody”, a expressão em destaque pode ser substituída, sem alteração de sentido, por



- (A) must.
- (B) could.
- (C) may.
- (D) used to.
- (E) going to.

## UNESP 2016

In the future, genetic modification could be aimed at altering the nutrient content of food, reducing its allergenic potential, or improving the efficiency of food production systems. All GM foods should be assessed before being allowed on the market. FAO/WHO Codex guidelines exist for risk analysis of GM food.

No trecho do segundo parágrafo “All GM foods **should** be assessed before being allowed on the market.”, o termo em destaque pode ser corretamente substituído, sem alteração de sentido, por

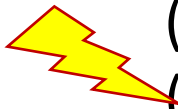
(A) could.

(B) has to.

(C) might.

(D) ought to.

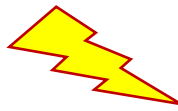
(E) used to.



## UNIFESP 2012

Tests have already shown that such a system can be used to control a voice-activated computer game, and one suggestion is that a stick-on voicebox circuit could be used in covert police operations where it **might** be too dangerous to speak into a radio transmitter. “The blurring of electronics and biology is really the key point here,” said Yonggang Huang, professor of engineering at Northwestern University in Evanston, Illinois. “All established forms of electronics are hard, rigid. Biology is soft, elastic. It’s two different worlds. This is a way to truly integrate them.”

In the excerpt of the fourth paragraph – *where it **might** be too dangerous to speak into a radio transmitter.* – the word *might* conveys an idea of



- (A) possibility.
- (B) ability.
- (C) request.
- (D) certainty.
- (E) demand.



## UNESP 2018

Tali Sharot, a cognitive neuroscientist at University College London, studies how our minds work and how we process new information. In her upcoming book, *The Influential Mind*, she explores why we ignore facts and how we can get people to actually listen to the truth. Tali shows that we're open to new information – but only if it confirms our existing beliefs. We find ways to ignore facts that challenge our ideals. And as neuroscientist Bahador Bahrami and colleagues have found, we weigh all opinions as equally valid, regardless of expertise.

So, having the data on your side is not always enough. For better or for worse, Sharot says, emotions may be the key to changing minds.

No trecho do quarto parágrafo “emotions may be the key to changing minds”, o termo sublinhado pode ser substituído, sem alteração de sentido no texto, por:

(A) must.

(B) has to.

(C) can.

(D) used to.

(E) will.



ME



ME ON A DIET

I SHOULD NOT  
BE EATING THIS!



UNESP 2020

Para o cartunista, a diferença entre estar ou não estar de dieta limita-se a um sentimento de

- (A) culpa.
- (B) euforia.
- (C) tristeza.
- (D) vazio.
- (E) satisfação.

# UNESP 2021

## When will the Amazon hit a tipping point?

Scientists say climate change, deforestation and fires could cause the world's largest rainforest to dry out. The big question is how soon that might happen. Seen from a monitoring tower above the treetops near Manaus, in the Brazilian Amazon, the rainforest canopy stretches to the horizon as an endless sea of green. It looks like a rich and healthy ecosystem, but appearances are deceiving. This rainforest — which holds 16,000 separate tree species — is slowly drying out.

### According to the text, the Amazon rainforest

- (A) might eventually dry out due to climate change, deforestation and fires.
- (B) has already regenerated itself since it looks green and healthy.
- (C) has lost over 16 thousand tree species over last decade.
- (D) appears large and resilient, so deforestation and fires will have a mild impact.
- (E) has already reached a state that makes it difficult to recover from fires and deforestation.

## FMABC 2021

Lots of us are doing big group chats for the first time, whether it's cooking and eating a virtual dinner, attending a university catch-up or holding a birthday party for a friend. If the call is meant to be fun, why might it feel tiring? Part of it is whether you're joining in because you want to or because you feel you ought to.

No trecho do sexto parágrafo “because you feel you ought to”, a expressão sublinhada pode ser substituída, sem alteração de sentido, por

(A) choose to.

 (B) have to.

(C) would like to.

(D) would prefer to.

(E) are told to.